

2. Network performance between two computers (A and B)

The interface

It provides a tabbed interface to control the various parameters of the test. The different tabs to control the parameters of the test:

1. Disk Targets tab: Specifies the disks used by each disk worker.
2. Network Targets tab: Specifies the network interfaces used by each network worker.
3. Access Specifications tab: Specifies the type of I/O operation each worker performs to its targets.
4. Results Display tab: Displays performance data during the test.
5. Test Setup tab: Specifies the tests to be performed in a test series.

The IOMeter Web site is very informative, and well-designed to assist the user.

5.3 Compression

Claim back disk space and reorder your files with the various compression tools reviewed here!

5.3.1 BZip2

(<http://gnuwin32.sourceforge.net/packages/bzip2.htm>)

bzip2 is a freely available, patent-free, high-quality data compressor. It claims to compress files to within 10% to 15% of the best available techniques (the PPM family of statistical compressors), while being around twice as fast at compression and six times faster at decompression.

It compresses most files more effectively than the traditional gzip or Zip, but is slower. This does not come with archiving functions, as bzip2 is only a data compressor. The program itself has no facilities for multiple files, encryption or archive-splitting. It instead relies on separate external utilities such as tar for these tasks.